Mo Daily News

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Today's Oil Headlines

Oil prices had their biggest weekly drop since 2022 last week, then steadied on Friday: Brent closed at $98.32 a barrel and US WTI at $90.83. Two triggers: first, Democrats won both houses of Congress in the US midterms, and the market expects limits on military action against Iran; second, signs of movement in the Qatar-mediated US–Iran nuclear talks. But tensions are far from over — another tanker incident was reported in the Strait of Hormuz on November 8, and US diesel stocks have fallen to their lowest in more than 20 years. Physical supply remains tight.

The News, Item by Item

1. Oil fell about 13% in a week, then steadied on Friday. Brent closed Friday at $98.32 a barrel and WTI at $90.83; Brent's roughly 13% weekly drop was its biggest since 2022, with a near-4% rebound on Thursday. The market sees the selloff as overdone, but volatility remains high. Source: https://www.rigzone.com/news/wire/oil_rebounds_after_sharp_iran_war_selloff-05-nov-2026-185023-article/?rss=true Source: https://leprivatebanker.com/2026/11/08/brent-gives-back-a-weeks-spike-but-inventories-and-hormuz-odds-show-a-market-still-tight/

2. OPEC+ froze December output targets; production is recovering toward pre-war levels. On November 1, Saudi Arabia, Russia and five other countries decided to keep December targets unchanged from September; a Bloomberg survey shows OPEC output last month had already recovered to near pre-war levels, led by Saudi Arabia. The next meeting is set for November 29. Source: https://anewz.tv/business/markets/26197/opec-holds-december-targets-as-oil-prices-fall/news Source: https://bakkenwire.com/article/morning-take-energy-market-briefing-2026-11-07-72pmx

3. Iran handed the US a nuclear proposal via Qatar, with seven preconditions. Iran submitted a written nuclear proposal to the US through Qatari mediators, but demanded seven conditions be met before talks and before reopening the Strait of Hormuz, including a ceasefire, unfreezing overseas assets, and lifting the maritime blockade and economic sanctions; Qatar says mediation continues. Source: https://infohandle.net/2026/11/07/tehran-seven-point-nuclear-proposal-qatar/

4. Another tanker incident in the Strait of Hormuz on November 8; the US had earlier struck Iranian air defenses. Iran said mines damaged three tankers, though Reuters said the claim could not be independently verified; the US military said its blockade of the strait has held back $25 billion worth of Iranian crude. Trump confirmed US forces struck an Iranian air-defense site on Qeshm Island on November 6. Source: https://worldofnow.com/finance/us-iran-hormuz-tanker-incidents-qatar-diplomacy-november-2026/ Source: https://bulletin.observer/news/us-strikes-iran-air-defenses-on-qeshm-as-nuclear-talks-continue-amid

5. US crude stocks fell for a fifth straight week; diesel stocks are the lowest since 2003. For the week ended October 30, US commercial crude stocks fell to 409.8 million barrels, a fifth straight weekly drop; distillate stocks including diesel fell to 99.3 million barrels, the lowest since May 2003 and 13% below the five-year average. Refinery utilisation rose to 94.5%. Source: https://www.morningstar.com/news/dow-jones/2026110410540/us-crude-oil-stockpiles-post-fifth-straight-weekly-drop

6. US crude output is on track for a record year. The US Energy Information Administration (EIA) expects US crude output to average 13.8 million barrels a day in 2026, above the 2025 record of 13.7 million, driven mainly by the Permian Basin in Texas and New Mexico and the Gulf of Mexico. Source: https://www.eia.gov/todayinenergy/detail.php?id=68125

7. Refining now earns more than producing; diesel is the tightest link. ExxonMobil's third-quarter refining profit was $9.05 billion, above its $7.31 billion upstream profit; US retail diesel at one point reached $6.32 a gallon. Even running flat out, refineries cannot keep up with diesel demand. Source: https://www.thestreet.com/markets/exxon-now-makes-more-turning-oil-into-diesel-than-pumping-it

8. Long-term outlook: global oil demand is expected to peak in 2032. Research published by Wood Mackenzie on November 5 says global refined-product demand will peak in 2032 and then enter structural decline, putting about one in five refineries worldwide at risk of closure; gasoline faces the biggest hit from electric vehicles, while diesel and jet fuel are more resilient. Source: https://thenewsheadliner.com/wood-mackenzie-one-in-five-refineries-at-closure-risk-as-global-oil-demand-peaks-in-2032/63867/

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